MAHATMA GANDHI UNIVERSITY, KOTTAYAM

MGU- UGP (HONOURS) REGULAR EXAMINATION MARCH 2025

SECOND SEMESTER

MDC- MG2MDCPSY100- PSYCHOLOGY OF FRIENDSHIP AND LOVE

(QP CODE: 25900169) Answer Key

Duration: 1.5 Hours **Maximum Marks: 50**

Remember(K), Understand(U), Apply(A), Analyse(An), Evaluate(E), Create(C), Skill(S), Interest(I) and Appreciation(Ap)

Part A- Multiple Choice Question

Answer all questions. Each question carries 1 mark

1.	1. What does the term 'proximity' refer to in the context of attraction? **b). Geographic and spatial closeness**	**[K] / [CO1]**
2.	Dislike towards homosexuals are referred to as: **b). Homophobia**	**[K] / [CO1]**
3.	Seeing one bad thing in a person might make you think that everything about them is bad. This is due to: **b). Devil/Horn Effect**	**[U] / [CO1]**
4.	Which of the following is an advantage of using smartphone for communication? **b). It allows instant access to information**	**[U] / [CO2]**
5.	What are the four categories of qualities contributing to physical attractiveness? **b). Neonate qualities, Mature features, Expressiveness, Grooming**	**[K] / [CO1]**
6.	Ross is going through a painful break-up. He is ruminating about his dissatisfaction, the costs of his relationship, and his alternatives. Steve Duck would say Ross going through which of the following processes? **b). Intrapsychic process**	**[A] / [CO2]**
7.	Which of the following is an example of strengthening online relationships? **c). Engaging in shared activities like online gaming and movie streaming**	**[U] / [CO2]**
8.	What emotional experience is more intense in people without desirable alternatives during break-ups? **d). Distress**	**[U] / [CO1]**

9.	A form of relationship maintenance that includes knowing and being known, making relationship-enhancing attributions for behaviours, accepting and respecting, and maintaining reciprocity and continuity is: **a). Minding**	**[K] / [CO3]**
10.	What are girls often taught about their sexual feelings? **a). To suppress or deny them**	**[U] / [CO3]**
11.	Which of the following is an example of fondness? **c). Feeling a strong bond with a family member**	**[U] / [CO4]**
12.	Which of the following is a mindful way to communicate with your partner? **a). Using "I" statements and active listening**	**[U] / [CO4]**
13.	What are some aspects of sexuality where males are more likely to engage than females**?** **b). Casual sex, using pornography, and masturbating**	**[An] / [CO3]**
14.	How do individuals with social phobia typically handle self-disclosure in romantic relationships? **b). They engage in less self-disclosure and report lower intimacy, emotional expression, and relationship satisfaction**	**[U] / [CO3]**
15.	Which conflict style is characterized by high concern for both self and others? **c). Collaborating**	**[An] / [CO4]**
16.	The term "glass ceiling " refers to: **c). An invisible barrier preventing women from advancing to top positions**	**[U] / [CO3]**
17.	Which of the following statements about gender differences is true? **d). Males express fewer emotions than females**	**[An] / [CO3]**
18.	What is one effect of traditional masculinity on men's emotional intelligence? **b). Reduces emotional awareness**	**[U] / [CO3]**
19.	What term is used to refer the Homosexual males? **a). Gay**	**[K] / [CO1]**
20.	What is one reason why similarity is appealing in relationships? **b). It makes people feel validated when others share their beliefs.**	**[U] / [CO1]**

(20×1=20)

Part B: Short Answer

Answer any 10 questions. Each question carries 3 marks

21.	**Describe Romantic Theory of love.** **Answer:** (Mark can be awarded to both theories of love- Sternberg's Triangular Theory as well as Romantic love as attachment.) **Sternberg's triangular theory of love:** Robert Sternberg's (1986, 1988, 2006) triangular theory of love posits that all love experiences are made up of **three components**: intimacy, passion, and commitment. • **Intimacy:** Feelings of warmth, (bond) closeness, connection, and sharing. • **Passion:** Intense feelings, both positive and negative, including sexual desire, excitement, and other strong emotions related to attraction and romance. • **Commitment:** The decision to maintain the relationship, even through difficulties **Eight different types of love** from different combinations of these 3 components. They are:1. Non love- All 3 components are absent; 2. Liking- Intimacy alone;3. Infatuation- Passion alone; 4. Empty Love- Commitment alone; 5. Romantic Love- Intimacy + Passion; 6. Fatuous Love - Passion + Commitment; 7. Companionate Love- Intimacy + Commitment; 8. Consummate Love - Intimacy + Passion + Commitment **OR** **Romantic love as attachment : Hazan and Shaver's Attachment Theory- Refer Q No. 23**	**[U] / [CO1]**
22.	**Outline Steve Duck's model of relationship Dissolution.** **Answer:** This model outlines six distinct processes that individuals go through when a relationship ends. It emphasizes that break-ups are a process, not a single event. The **six stages are**: **1. Breakdown Processes:** Initial stage where one or both partners become dissatisfied with the relationship. It's the recognition that something is wrong. **2. Intra-psychic Processes:** If the breakdown is severe enough, individuals begin to ruminate internally. They think about their dissatisfaction, weigh the costs of staying in the relationship, and consider potential alternatives. This is an internal process. **3. Dyadic Processes:** This involves communication and negotiation between the partners. They discuss the problems and attempt to	**[U] / [CO2]**

	resolve the conflict. It's a crucial point where the relationship could potentially be repaired. **4. Social Processes:** If the dyadic processes fail and the decision to end the relationship is made, the couple begins to share the news with their social network (friends and family). This stage involves managing the social fallout of the break-up. **5. Grave-Dressing Processes:** After the break-up, each partner constructs their own narrative or "story" about why the relationship ended. This narrative is shared with their social network and helps them make sense of the break-up and justify their actions. **6. Resurrection Processes:** This involves each partner preparing for their new life as a single individual. They reflect on the past relationship, learn from the experience, and move forward.	
23.	**Discuss the topic "Romantic Love as an Attachment".** **Answer:** Hazan & Shaver's Attachment Theory. Attachment styles refers to the typical ways of interacting in close relationships. Theorists believe that attachment styles develop during the Ist year of life and strongly influence individuals' interpersonal interactions from then on. Cindy Hazan and Phillip Shaver (1987) asserted that adult romantic love and infant attachment share a number of **features such as** ; 1. Intense fascination with the other person; 2. Distress at separation; 3.Efforts to stay close and spend time together. **Three attachment styles are;** 1. Secure Attachment style; 2. Anxious-Ambivalent Attachment Style; 3. Avoidant Attachment Style. **Three parenting styles** that influence attachment styles are: **A warm/responsive approach** seems to promote secure attachments, whereas **An ambivalent/ inconsistent style** seems to result in anxious-ambivalent attachments. A **cold/rejecting style** is associated with avoidant attachments. Infant attachment styles continue into adult attachment styles and influence their romantic relationships. • **Secure adults:** Trust others, find it easy to get close to them, and are comfortable with mutual dependence. They rarely worry about being abandoned by their partner. Secure adults have the longest-lasting relationships and the fewest divorces. • **Anxious-ambivalent adults**: are obsessive and preoccupied with their relationships. They want more relationship closeness than their partners do and suffer extreme feelings of jealousy, based on fears of abandonment.	**[U] / [CO1]**

	• **Avoidant adults**: both fear and feel uncomfortable about getting close to others. They are reluctant to trust others and prefer to maintain emotional distance from others.	
24.	**Differentiate between close relationships and casual social relationships with examples.** **Answer:** Close relationships are relationships that are important, interdependent, and long lasting. Characteristics of people in close relationships include; Spend a lot of time and energy maintaining the relationship; What one person says and does affects the other**;** Partners are irreplaceable. Close relationships come in many forms such as; family relationships, friendships**,** work relationships**,** romantic relationships**,** marriage etc. In casual social relationships (such as between store clerk and customer), partners can be interchangeable (Livesay & Duck, 2009).	**[U] / [CO1]**
25.	**What is Interdependence Theory (Social Exchange Theory) and how does it explain relationship maintenance?** **Answer:** Interdependence or Social Exchange Theory (Harold Kelley & John Thibaut) postulates that interpersonal relationships are governed by perceptions of the rewards and costs exchanged in interactions. **Rewards** include such things as emotional support, status, and sexual gratification (in romantic relationships); **Costs** are such things as the time and energy that a relationship requires. **The interactions** between acquaintances, friends, and lovers will continue as long as the participants feel that the benefits they derive from the relationship are reasonable in comparison to the costs of being in the relationship. Individuals assess their satisfaction with a relationship by comparing the relationship outcomes (rewards minus costs) to their subjective expectations. **Relationship maintenance involves** the actions and activities used to sustain the desired quality of a relationship. They can be: Spontaneous (e.g., checking in, shared meals) or Intentional (e.g., visiting family/friends). Both spontaneous and intentional maintenance activities are linked to relationship satisfaction and commitment. Relationship satisfaction is higher when the frequency of maintenance behaviours aligns with expectations or when contributions are perceived as equitable.	**[U] / [CO1]**
26.	**Why is collaborating considered the most effective conflict management style?**	**[U] / [CO4]**

	Answer: Collaborating style encompass high concern for self and others. In this approach, • Conflict is viewed as a mutual problem to be solved as effectively as possible. • Both individuals take time to sit and communicate about the conflict. • Collaborating encourages openness and honesty. • It stresses the importance of criticizing the other person‘s ideas in a disagreement rather than the other person. • Individuals work on clarifying differences and similarities in positions so that they can build on the similarities. • most productive approach for dealing with conflict. • Instead of resulting in a post conflict residue of tension and resentment, collaborating tends to produce a climate of trust.	
27.	**Why is assertiveness considered a healthier communication style?** **Answer:** Assertiveness is the ability to communicate one’s needs, wants, feelings, and opinions in a direct, honest, and respectful manner. It is considered healthier and more effective than passive/submissive or aggressive communication styles. **Passive/Submissive Communication:** Submissive individuals often allow others to take advantage of them. They have difficulty saying no to unreasonable requests and struggle to voice disagreement or make their own requests. **Aggressive Communication:** Aggressive communication focuses on getting what one wants, regardless of how it affects others. It often disregards the feelings and rights of others. **Benefits of Assertive Communication** • Balances self-respect with respect for others. • Allows individuals to clearly and directly state what they want. • Encourages mutual understanding and healthy boundaries. • Helps individuals feel good about themselves and leads others to respond positively.	**[U] / [CO4]**
28.	**What are the implications of gender stereotypes on the emotional expression and intimacy within the romantic relationship?** **Males** are socialized to appear strong, tough, and detached (Jansz, 2000), leading them to suppress emotions like love, joy, and sadness, which are viewed as feminine and signs of weakness. Over time, this may cause them to lose touch with their own emotional lives. In	**[An] / [CO3]**

	addition, those adhering to traditional masculinity often express only anger, avoiding other emotions to maintain composure (Jakupcak et al., 2003). This emotional suppression can lead to stress, miscommunication, and relationship strain. **Females** are generally encouraged to express emotions such as empathy and sadness and are expected to be emotional caretakers. While this enhances emotional awareness, it also increases emotional responsibility. Women are often pressured to manage both their own and their partner's emotions, leading to emotional fatigue or resentment. In relationships, **men's emotional inexpressiveness**, particularly the lack of love and warmth, can hinder intimacy and lead to emotional distance. It can be very difficult to develop or maintain intimacy under such conditions. **Women** may feel unsupported and unfulfilled when their partners are unresponsive, resulting in communication breakdowns, reduced satisfaction, and emotional isolation within the relationship.	
29.	**What are the benefits and challenges of juggling multiple roles for women?** **Multiple Roles:** Women commonly juggle three major roles: spouse, parent, and worker, while men typically focus primarily on the worker role. In contrast, men typically focus primarily on the **worker** role. **Challenges:** The imbalance in role expectations often leads to: • Increased **stress** and **conflict** for women who strive to "have it all" (career and family). • **Postponement of marriage and motherhood** by college-educated women to pursue education and career goals. • **Anticipation of career disruptions** due to childrearing responsibilities. • **Temporary withdrawal** from high-powered careers by some women to focus on raising young children, reflecting the belief: *"You can have it all, just not all at the same time"* **Benefits:** Despite the challenges, juggling multiple roles can offer positive outcomes: • Multiple roles are **not inherently negative**. • They can be **beneficial for mental health**. The key issue lies in **role conflicts** and the **unequal distribution of responsibilities**, not the number of roles themselves.	**[U] / [CO3]**

30.	**Discuss the main findings of Petersen and Hyde's meta-analysis (2010, 2011) regarding gender differences in sexual behaviour and attitudes.** **Answer:** In the sexual domain, a meta-analysis by Petersen and Hyde (2010, 2011) found that: • Men are slightly more likely to engage in sexual activity and tend to have more sexual partners. • Men are slightly more permissive in their attitudes toward sex in general, while women are more likely than men to feel negative emotions (such as shame or guilt) in response to sex. • The researchers found larger differences for some aspects of sexuality. Specifically, males are more likely than females to engage in casual sex, use pornography, and masturbate. But, in line with the gender similarities hypothesis, most gender differences regarding sexuality are relatively small.	**[An] / [CO3]**
31.	**Explain the five component model of minding proposed by social psychologist John Harvey.** **Answer:** The five-component model of minding relationships are; 1**. Knowing and Being Known:** Partners actively seek to understand each other's hopes, fears, and vulnerabilities. 2.**Making Relationship-Enhancing Attributions**: Positive behaviours are attributed to the partner's disposition (internal causes). Negative behaviours are attributed to external, situational factors. 3. **Accepting and respecting:** This requires an empathic connection, along with refined social skills. Accepting the partner with their flaws and respecting their individuality. 4. **Maintaining reciprocity in minding:** Each partner's active participation and involvement in relationship-enhancing thoughts and behaviours‖ is necessary for maintaining a mutually beneficial relationship. Lack of conscious engagement by one partner can cause frustration or contempt in the other. 5**. Maintaining continuity in minding** may also involve planning and strategizing to strengthen closeness as the relationship matures. Partners who regularly check in on each other's goals and needs are more likely to recognize what is and isn't working in the minding process.	**[U] / [CO3]**
32.	**How can timing affect the outcome of conflict resolution?** • Hit the "Ripe Moment": Resolve when everyone feels stuck and wants a solution, not too early or too late.	**[A] / [CO4]**

	• Emotional Readiness: Address conflict when emotions are calm enough for clear thinking and listening. • Grab the next best opportunity to solve it, do not put it away /avoid communication for long time. (Conflict delayed is conflict multiplied): Leverage upcoming deadlines or new chances to push for resolution. (Other practical/ sensible effect of timing can also be considered right.)	
33.	**How do beliefs about conflict influence the way individuals handle disagreements?** **Answer:** Beliefs about conflict strongly influence how individuals handle disagreements by shaping their emotional responses and behavioural choices. **Negative beliefs**, such as thinking that conflict is inherently bad, often lead individuals to avoid conflict creating a **self-perpetuating cycle**. This cycle typically unfolds as follows: 1. individuals view conflict negatively; 2. they feel anxious when faced with a conflict; 3. they avoid addressing the conflict for as long as possible; 4. the unresolved conflict escalates and eventually demands confrontation; 5. the confrontation is handled poorly. This negative experience reinforces the tendency to avoid conflict in the future, often resulting in similarly unsatisfactory outcomes. In contrast, **positive or neutral beliefs**—such as seeing conflict as a natural and potentially productive part of relationships—enable individuals to deal with disagreements more openly and constructively. This can:1. Solve underlying problems. 2. Reduce ongoing tension. 3. Encourage new insights and understanding. Individuals who believe conflict is dangerous or damaging tend to avoid or mishandle it, while those who view it as natural or useful are more likely to engage constructively and resolve disagreements effectively. **Styles of conflict management** (avoiding, accommodating, competing, compromising, collaborating) are often shaped by these underlying beliefs. In reality, conflict is neither inherently bad nor inherently good. It is a natural phenomenon that may lead to either good or bad outcomes, depending on how people deal with it.	**[An] / [CO4]**

(10×3=30)